CIVIC WISE · ZAMBIA

Running a Civic Workshop: Activity Guide

A simple plan for a 90-minute facilitated session, low-tech and low-data.

Before you start. Download the course for offline use on your own phone so it works without a signal. Create a cohort in the trainer area and share the join code, or add learners by email, so you can track who took part.

Session plan (90 minutes)

Time	Activity
0–10 min	Welcome. Ask: "What is one thing you wish worked better in our community?" Note answers on paper.
10–30 min	Work through one short lesson together (read aloud or on phones). Pause to explain in local language.
30–50 min	Discussion using the prompts in the Discussion Guide. Keep every voice welcome.
50–70 min	Run a scenario (e.g. an unresolved problem). Vote on each choice before revealing the feedback.
70–85 min	Practice: in pairs, draft a real complaint or question about a local issue.
85–90 min	Mark attendance in the cohort. Agree one action each person will take this week.

Three ready activities

1. **Right office, right door.** Call out everyday problems (broken borehole, lost NRC, market dispute). The group shouts which office handles each. Clear up any confusion together.
2. **Make it land.** Give the group a weak, vague complaint. In pairs, rewrite it to be short, factual and specific. Read the best ones aloud.

3. **Check before you share.** Show a dramatic (invented) message. Ask the group how they would check whether it is true before forwarding it.

Tips for facilitators

- Keep it practical. Tie every lesson to a real local example.
- Let people disagree respectfully. That is civic life in practice.
- Low literacy is fine: read aloud, use the audio lessons, and discuss in local language.
- End with one concrete action each person commits to. Follow up at the next session.

Civic Wise: free civic and digital skills for communities in Zambia.

Facilitator material · may be printed and shared.